

Class 2 - Research II: Positions

Agenda

- Skills corner: Reading articles (10 minutes)
- Conceptual grounding (5 minutes)
- Core paper discussion (60 minutes)
- Break (5 minutes)
- Summative lecture on concepts (30 minutes)
 - Defining a research landscape
 - Key thinking tool: Thinking about thinking

Skills corner

Strategic reading of scholarly articles

Questions to guide you

- Why are you reading this article right now? [What information do you want to focus on / extract?]
- What might you use the information in the article for in the future? [How 'deeply' should you read?]
- Do you expect to read this piece over and over? [How do you want to allocate effort over those reads?]
- What do you already know about the topic? [What information is redundant and can be skipped?]

Some resources to start from

Here are some library resource guides with different strategies

- My aspirational process

M. WIDEN, *How to Read a Book*, 2013

Grounding

Research design “positions”

We must ask ourselves for a given project where we stand regarding the following:

- The trilemma: generalizability, precision, and realism
- A related tension: rigor vs. relevance
- Conversation topic: what you want to say vs. what the audience wants to know
- What claim(s) to assert: stylized facts, assumptions, critiques, and omissions

Core Paper Discussion

Readings

- 1 Huff, A. S. (1999). Writing for Scholarly Publication. SAGE. [Chs. 1, 3]
- 2 McGrath, Joseph E. (1981) Dilemmatics: The Study of Research Choices and Dilemmas, American Behavioral Scientist, 25, 2, 179-210
- 3 Simsek, Z., Heavey, C., Fox, B. C., & Yu, T. 2022. Compelling Questions in Research. Journal of Management, 48(6), 1347-1365.
- 4 Tushman, M., & O'Reilly, C. (2007). Research and Relevance: Implications of Pasteur's Quadrant for Doctoral Programs and Faculty Development. The Academy of Management Journal, 50, No. 4, 769-774.

Huff (1999)

Lecture - Positions

Defining a landscape for research questions

Dimensions we have discussed today:

- To what end? Rigor (understanding) and relevance (use)
- By doing what? Precision, generalizability, and realism
- With whom? What matters to you v. what matters to others
- Means of advance? Types of knowledge claims and their level of development

Defining a landscape for research questions

How might they be correlated with each other?

- Rigor and relevance:
 - Orthogonal ($r = 0$?)
 - In opposition ($r = -1$?)
- Precision, generalizability, and realism:
 - How do each map onto rigor and relevance?

Thinking about Thinking

Some useful types of thinking when engaging in the research process:

- Skeptical thinking
- Bayesian thinking
- Strategic thinking
- First principles thinking

Skeptical thinking

"Science depends on organized skepticism, that is, on continual, methodical doubting. Few of us doubt our own conclusions, so science embraces its skeptical approach by rewarding those who doubt someone else's." Neil de-Grasse Tyson, Origins: Fourteen Billion Years of Cosmic

Preparation for Next Class

Next class - Workshop!

- We will have a workshop session about four hours long. For the first two hours or so, students will **make a three-minute presentation about their research topic/idea** for their dissertation.
- This can involve a few PowerPoint slides to help guide the discussion. It may be a broad topic or specific question; this will vary by student.
- The balance of the workshop will be group work to discuss and advance those research questions; I will move from group to group to facilitate discussions.

Expectations

- I am NOT looking for something super polished